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Hegseth orders a muster of top brass

Mystery meeting in Va. for generals and admirals sows alarm, confusion

This article is by Tara Copp, Dan Lamothe, Alex Horton, Ellen Nakashima and Noah Robertson

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth has ordered hundreds of the U.S. military's generals and admirals to gather on short notice — and without a stated reason — at a Marine Corps base in Virginia next week, sowing confusion and alarm after the Trump administration's firing of numerous senior leaders this year.

The highly unusual directive was sent to virtually all of the military's top commanders worldwide, according to more than a dozen people familiar with the matter. It was issued earlier this week, against the backdrop of a potential government shutdown, and as Hegseth's overtly political moves have deepened a sense of distress among his opponents who fear that he is erasing the Defense Department's status as a nonpartisan institution.

In a statement Thursday, Pentagon spokesman Sean Parnell affirmed that Hegseth "will be addressing his senior military leaders early next week," but he offered no additional details. Parnell, a senior adviser to the defense secretary, voiced no security concerns about The Washington Post reporting on the meeting, scheduled for Tuesday in Quantico, Virginia.

It was not clear whether President Donald Trump will attend the meeting or if Hegseth had given the president advance notice of his plans. He told reporters in the Oval Office on Thursday afternoon that he will go "if they want me."

Despite the meeting's size and secrecy, both Trump and Vice President JD Vance downplayed its significance, with Trump asking, "Why is that such a big deal?" Vance, appearing alongside Trump, said it is "not particularly unusual" that generals are speaking with Hegseth. "I think it's odd

SEE HEGSETH ON A5

Gaza's threadbare health system is buckling



EYAD BABA/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A Palestinian man and woman navigate the rubble of a building hit by an Israeli strike in the Nuseirat refugee camp in the central Gaza Strip on Thursday. Israel's ground invasion of Gaza City has put several hospitals and more than two dozen primary health care providers out of service, medical staff and the U.N. said. **Story, A10**

Trump signs order advancing spin-off of TikTok

BY DREW HARWELL

President Donald Trump signed an executive order Thursday to help advance a spin-off of TikTok in the United States to a group of mostly American investors, further pushing the influential app with 170 million U.S. users into the hands of some of Trump's wealthiest allies.

The deal will allow the video app to stay online in the U.S.

Deal would create U.S. version of app owned by president's wealthy allies

following a law passed last year by a bipartisan majority of Congress demanding that its owner, the Chinese tech giant ByteDance, sell the app or have it

banned nationwide.

Federal officials had warned that the Chinese government could use the app to harvest Americans' data or secretly shape the videos they watch, though they never shared any evidence that such concerns had come to pass.

Trump's order Thursday postponed the law from taking effect for 120 days while negotiators finalized the deal. It marked

Trump's fifth postponement of the law's enforcement, despite criticisms that a president did not have the authority to unilaterally overturn a law upheld by the Supreme Court.

Speaking from the Oval Office, Trump said that the company would be run by "very sophisticated ... very smart" Americans and that Chinese President Xi Jinping had given the deal "the

SEE TIKTOK ON A16

Dallas shooter intended to harm ICE agents, officials say

This article is by Molly Hennessy-Fiske, Anumita Kaur, Angie Orellana Hernandez, Victoria Crow and Niha Masih

FAIRVIEW, TEXAS — The gunman who opened fire on Immigration and Customs En-

forcement facility in Dallas on Wednesday intended to harm ICE agents and planned the attack for months, officials said at a news conference Thursday, citing notes found in the shooter's home.

Joshua Jahn, 29, of Fairview,

Texas, killed one detainee and critically wounded two others before fatally shooting himself, acting U.S. attorney Nancy E. Larson said.

It was the latest of several deadly attacks that appear to be politically motivated, including

the fatal shooting of conservative activist Charlie Kirk this month, the slayings of a Minnesota state lawmaker and her husband in June, and the killings of two Israeli Embassy employees outside a gathering of Jewish young

SEE SHOOTING ON A6

SARA JANE MOORE | 1930-2025

Ideological drifter attempted to assassinate Ford

BY PAUL W. VALENTINE

Sara Jane Moore, a onetime FBI informant who tried and failed to assassinate President Gerald Ford in 1975, died Sept. 24, two days after the shooting's 50th anniversary. She was 95.

Her death, at a nursing home in Franklin, Tennessee, was confirmed by her friend Demetria Kalodimos, a journalist who first reported Ms. Moore's death in an article for the Nashville Banner. Information on the cause was not immediately available.

Ms. Moore's release from federal prison in California in 2007 after more than 32 years behind bars climaxed a dramatic and wayward life. She was variously described by those who knew her as charming and abrasive, impulsive and brooding, and intermittently depressed and suicidal.

She was a troubled ideological drifter, a suburban Republican matriarch, who in the political ferment of San Francisco in the late 1960s and early 1970s was abrupt-

SEE MOORE ON A7



JIM PALMER/AP

Sara Jane Moore in 1975, before she pleaded guilty in her attempt to kill President Gerald Ford.

Federal agencies face mass layoffs in shutdown standoff

White House warns of new cuts if no funding deal emerges by Oct. 1

BY RILEY BEGGIN, HANNAH NATANSON AND THEODORIC MEYER

The White House is preparing federal agencies for widespread layoffs if the government shuts down next week, leaving new uncertainty about what would close and what would stay open if funding runs out Oct. 1.

The prospect has shaken the federal workforce, which has already undergone sweeping layoffs this year under the U.S. DOGE Service and is now scrambling to understand who could lose their jobs as soon as Wednesday.

President Donald Trump told reporters Thursday that there "could be" a shutdown, which he preemptively blamed on Democrats.

The White House Office of Management and Budget issued a memo late Wednesday directing agencies to consider firing employees working on any program that is not funded by another law, such as Republicans' One Big Beautiful Bill Act enacted in July, and which does not align with Trump's priorities. Once government funding is reinstated after a shutdown, agencies should revise their plans to keep only the smallest number of employees necessary to legally operate, the memo says.

Any such layoffs would add to those initiated earlier this year, the memo says. DOGE offered to pay thousands of federal employees through Sept. 30 to leave their jobs, although some agencies have since tried to rehire workers over concerns that the personnel cuts made it difficult to perform some functions.

The memo also increases pressure on congressional Democrats, who have insisted they will not support a funding extension

SEE OMB ON A2

IN THE NEWS

Amazon's FTC settlement The company will pay \$1.5 billion in refunds to customers who subscribed to Prime over allegations it made the shipping service hard to cancel. **A14**

The best and worst of Trump A Post poll this month garnered feedback from supporters and critics of the president on his actions. **A4**

THE NATION Democratic candidates for Senate are keeping their distance from Charles E. Schumer. **A3**
The parents of a missing child at Camp Mystic seek to halt plans to reopen next summer. **A7**

THE WORLD Analysts are skeptical Ukraine can win back all its land absent a major shift in support. **A9**
After years of chaos, Lebanese leadership garners record approval, a poll finds. **A11**

THE ECONOMY A year after a federal judge rejected lawsuits linking Tylenol and autism, Trump's charges on Monday amplified the issue again. **A14**
The White House set off heated exchanges online when it used a tweet by Tylenol against the company. **A15**

STYLE Amanda Knox and Monica Lewinsky team up on a series about Knox's 2007 wrongful murder accusation. **B1**

SPORTS Jeremy Reaves built his reputation on special teams for the Commanders. The defense needs him now. **B7**

THE REGION Members of the House Natural Resources Committee will investigate the U.S. Park Police's car chase policy. **B13**

WEEKEND Nearby farms are opening their gates for fall fun: the season's best festivals, pumpkin patches and corn mazes.

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